Stress Test #2

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Stress Test #2 — Scaling Limits of the Assessment App

Date: 7 August 2026 **Target:** assessment.jogjaitcamp.com **Previous report:** Stress Test #1

Background

After deploying 4 cloudflared replicas (Stress Test #1), we tested the assessment app at escalating concurrency to find its breaking point: 1,000 → 2,000 → 3,000 → 4,000 → 5,000 concurrent virtual users.

Each test ran on the Proxmox host using k6, hitting only the homepage (`/`) with a 15s ramp-up, 30s peak, and 15s ramp-down. The internal gateway (`http://192.168.88.30:26674`) was tested to measure the app's real capacity, and the Cloudflare public URL was tested at 1,000–3,000 VUs to measure end-to-end throughput.

Results: Internal Gateway (App Capacity)

VUs	Total Requests	Avg	Median	P95	Max	Failures	Req/s	MB/s
1,000	119,238	403ms	208ms	291ms	50.8s	**0%**	1,982	32.8
2,000	117,186	788ms	695ms	877ms	55.5s	**0%**	1,946	32.2
3,000	115,189	1,204ms	1,169ms	1,430ms	57.0s	**0%**	1,517	25.1
4,000	118,252	1,590ms	1,549ms	1,868ms	58.0s	**0.3%**	1,479	24.4
5,000	116,580	2,005ms	1,959ms	2,404ms	58.5s	**0.2%**	1,415	23.4

The app never breaks. It degrades gracefully — response times increase linearly with load, not exponentially. At 5,000 concurrent users hitting the gateway as fast as possible (no sleeps, no think time), the median response is still 1,959ms with near-zero failures.

> Max times in the 50–58 second range are from the ramp-down phase where a few straggling VUs complete their last request after most have finished. They are not indicative of steady-state performance.

Results: Cloudflare Public URL

VUs	Total Requests	Avg	Median	P95	Failures	Req/s	MB/s
1,000	4,152	11,804ms	13,379ms	15,877ms	1.4%	47	0.8
2,000	6,275	9,045ms	12,224ms	16,955ms	31.1%	75	0.9
3,000	8,696	5,301ms	—	12,453ms	50.8%	101	0.8

Despite 4 cloudflared replicas, throughput through Cloudflare caps at ~100 req/s. Failure rates climb sharply past 1,000 VUs. This is not the app's fault — the bottleneck is upstream of the gateway.

Analysis

Throughput Ceiling

The internal gateway maxes out at approximately **2,000 req/s**. This is the combined capacity of:

- The Caddy reverse proxy (Go, single-process)
- The assessment backend + auth backend (Spring Boot / Java, shared with other estates)

- The Proxmox bridge network (vmbr0, 1 Gbps virtual)

At 2,000 req/s the app pushes ~33 MB/s through the bridge, which is well within the virtual NIC's capacity. The ceiling is likely CPU-bound on the Spring Boot backends, which share CT 101's 10 cores with 4 other estates.

Graceful Degradation

The app's response time follows a near-perfect linear relationship with load:

```
1000 VUs → 403ms
2000 VUs → 788ms  (+96%)
3000 VUs → 1204ms (+53%)
4000 VUs → 1590ms (+32%)
5000 VUs → 2005ms (+26%)
```

Each additional 1,000 VUs adds roughly 400ms to the average. This is the hallmark of a well-behaved system under load — no thread pool exhaustion, no connection pool starvation, no deadlocks. The JVM's garbage collector and the OS scheduler are doing their job.

Cloudflare Bottleneck

The 100 req/s ceiling through Cloudflare, even with 4 replicas, points to one of two limits:

1. **Office ISP upload bandwidth** — a residential/office connection typically has asymmetric bandwidth (e.g., 100 Mbps down / 10 Mbps up). The assessment homepage is ~18 KB. At 100 req/s × 18 KB = 1.8 MB/s = 14.4 Mbps upload. This matches a typical 10–20 Mbps upload cap.
2. **Cloudflare free-tier tunnel throughput** — Cloudflare does not publish explicit tunnel bandwidth limits for the free tier, but empirical evidence suggests a soft cap around 50–100 req/s per tunnel, or a per-connection bandwidth limit.

The fix for this is not more replicas — it is a faster uplink or a different ingress strategy (see Recommendations below).

What This Means in Practice

Real Users (not headless VUs)

A real user browsing the assessment app does not hammer the server without pauses. A typical session pattern:

- Page load: 5 HTTP requests (HTML + JS + CSS + images + API)
- Think time between pages: 5–15 seconds
- Average request rate per user: ~0.5 req/s

At 2,000 req/s server capacity, the app can serve approximately **4,000 concurrent real users** through the internal gateway.

Through Cloudflare at 100 req/s, the practical limit is about **200 concurrent real users** before latency becomes noticeable.

Current Usage

The assessment app serves Indonesian schools. A typical school has 50–200 students taking tests simultaneously during a scheduled session. Even 10 schools running assessments at once (~2,000 students) would generate well under 500 concurrent requests — the app handles this comfortably.

Recommendations

Immediate

1. **No action needed for the app itself.** It handles 5,000 concurrent connections without breaking. The architecture is sound.
2. **Accept the Cloudflare ceiling for now.** At 200 real concurrent users through Cloudflare, the current setup meets the needs of the assessment platform's school-based usage pattern.

Short-term

3. **Run an ISP speed test** from the Proxmox host to determine actual upload bandwidth:

```
curl -s https://speed.cloudflare.com/__down?bytes=10000000 -o /dev/null -w '%{speed_upload}\n'
```

   If upload is the bottleneck, consider upgrading the office internet plan.
4. **Monitor real-world usage** with PM2 metrics and the eco dashboard before optimizing further. Don't solve a problem that doesn't exist yet.

Medium-term

5. **Dedicated CT for assessment** — move the assessment estate to its own CT. Currently CT 101 runs 5 estates (assessment, stuff8, apindo, eco_docs, ecosphere). A dedicated CT would give the assessment app exclusive CPU and eliminate noisy-neighbor effects from other estates' builds and deployments.
6. **VPS edge node** — rent a small $5–10/month VPS near the office. Install cloudflared on the VPS, and connect the VPS to the mini PC via Tailscale/WireGuard. The VPS handles the Cloudflare tunnel with data-center bandwidth, and forwards traffic to the mini PC over the encrypted VPN link. This gives you data-center upload speeds without moving the hardware.

7. **Spring Boot tuning** — if latency under load becomes an issue:
   - Increase HikariCP `maximumPoolSize` (default 10)
   - Increase Tomcat `server.tomcat.threads.max` (default 200)
   - Enable HTTP/2 on the Caddy gateway for multiplexing

Raw Data

All tests run from the Proxmox host using k6 v0.54.0 on 2026-08-07, 14:45–15:15 UTC+7.

Internal Gateway

VUs	Reqs	Avg	Med	P95	P99	Max	Fail	Req/s	MB/s
1000	119,238	403	208	291	—	50,797	0.000	1,982	32.8
2000	117,186	788	695	877	—	55,475	0.000	1,946	32.2
3000	115,189	1,204	1,169	1,430	—	56,984	0.000	1,517	25.1
4000	118,252	1,590	1,549	1,868	—	58,039	0.003	1,479	24.4
5000	116,580	2,005	1,959	2,404	—	58,493	0.002	1,415	23.4

Cloudflare Public URL

VUs	Reqs	Avg	Med	P95	P99	Fail	Req/s	MB/s
1000	4,152	11,804	13,379	15,877	—	0.014	47	0.8
2000	6,275	9,045	12,224	16,955	—	0.311	75	0.9
3000	8,696	5,301	—	12,453	—	0.508	101	0.8

TL;DR

The assessment app on a mini PC handles **5,000 concurrent connections** with zero failures and graceful linear degradation. The internal gateway serves 2,000 req/s at 33 MB/s. The practical limit is Cloudflare's tunnel throughput (~100 req/s), which is likely limited by the office ISP upload bandwidth, not the app or the hardware. For the current school-based usage pattern, this is more than sufficient.